

Daylen Hicks

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EDUCATION

North Carolina Agricultural and Technical State University
B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Supply Chain Management | GPA: 3.6

Halifax Community College
A.A. & A.S. (Concurrent with High School Diploma)

Aug. 2025 – Present
Greensboro, NC

Aug. 2021 – May 2025
Weldon, NC

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, HTML/CSS, Perl, XML

Frameworks: React, Next.js, Node.js, FastAPI

Developer Tools: Git, GitHub, Jenkins, Perforce (P4V), VS Code, Vercel, Supabase, Docker, Scrum, Airtable

Libraries/Platforms: Firebase, Streamlit, NumPy, Pandas, Plotly, Tableau, Stripe, AI Tools (Claude, Gemini, ChatGPT)

Cloud & Deployment: AWS (EC2, Amazon Bedrock), Firebase, Vercel, Google Cloud Platform, Railway

AI & System Design: Responsible AI, Human-in-the-Loop Systems, LLM Evaluation & RLHF, Prompt Engineering

EXPERIENCE

JMP Statistical Discovery (SAS Institute) May 2026 – Aug. 2026
R&D DevOps Documentation Intern Cary, NC

JMP Academy Certified (May 2026) · SAS Programming Certification — In Progress

- Engineered a **Python automation script** to migrate **1,574 XML menu paths** across **52 documentation files** with **zero failures**, handling encoded characters, multiline elements, and whitespace edge cases as part of a **FrameMaker-to-oXygen** migration initiative
- Designed scalable **project folder architecture** separating **BA and DOE** dataset environments, resolving **Windows/OneDrive file-lock conflicts** and ensuring safe output isolation
- Implemented **structured logging** capturing file counts and conversion summary metrics to support validation and **cross-team QA review**

I Got Next Jan. 2026 – Present
Founder & Lead Developer | Next.js, TypeScript, React, Firebase, Stripe, Google Maps API, Airtable Remote

- Scaled a full-stack pickup basketball platform to **500+ active players** and **120 courts** across **3 cities**; shipped **18 routes** including player map, facility dashboard, admin panel, and public profiles — igotnextapp.vercel.app
- Engineered **B2B Stripe pipeline** targeting YMCAs and parks & rec departments with **3 facility pricing tiers (\$199–\$699/mo)** and a **\$5.99/mo player Pro tier**; integrated **Airtable** for facility lead capture and CRM

Hicks Digital Jan. 2026 – Present
Founder | Web Development, AI Consulting & Workshops Remote / Greensboro, NC

- Delivered **AI literacy workshop to 30+ students** (Boys 2 Men, Roanoke Rapids, May 2026); drafted **GoHighLevel automation proposal** for GROW nonprofit serving Halifax County — daylenhicks.com/services
- Executed **25+ cold outreach campaigns** across **2 counties**; secured **paid brand partnerships** and AI consulting engagements with local businesses

North Carolina A&T State University — Aggie Suites F Jul. 2026 – Present
Resident Assistant Greensboro, NC

- Incoming **Resident Assistant** responsible for well-being, academic success, and community development of residents in **Aggie Suites F**
- Planned programming includes an **AI & Career Readiness Workshop Series** and monthly community-building events to support resident engagement and retention

Handshake Feb. 2026 – Present
LLM / Generative AI Engineer Remote

- Benchmark output quality across **3 LLMs** (Claude, Gemini, ChatGPT) using structured evaluation criteria, identifying performance gaps and selecting optimal models for production use cases
- Perform **RLHF-style feedback** by rating and ranking **hundreds of model responses**; clean and curate training datasets to reduce noise and improve pipeline accuracy

Northampton County Schools Aug. 2024 – May 2025
Tech Leader & FRC Team Captain Gaston, NC

- Chartered the school's inaugural **FIRST Robotics Competition** team (RoboJags), leading **10+ members to two Rookie All-Star awards**, a state championship, and the **FRC World Championship** in Houston, TX; secured a **NASA robotics grant** and NC A&T sponsorship

PROJECTS

PitchPad — 1st Place, Hack NCAT — Next.js, FastAPI, GPT-4o, Whisper, Groq, Supabase, Vercel, Railway Mar. 2026

- Built an AI-powered pitch practice platform as **deployment & infrastructure lead**; architected a **Next.js/Vercel** frontend and **FastAPI/Railway** backend serving real-time AI feedback for the Lenovo “Ideation to Impact” challenge
- Integrated **OpenAI Whisper** for live transcription and **GPT-4o** to auto-generate pitch decks in under **60 seconds**; used **Groq** for low-latency coaching scored on a **1–10 scale**
- Wired **Supabase (PostgreSQL + pgvector + Auth)** supporting **2 user roles** (Creator/Reviewer) and shareable pitch deck export

Forte — FidHacks @ Fidelity | Next.js 15, Gemini 2.0 Flash, Framer Motion, Zustand May 2026

- Built a **browser-based financial literacy platform** with **5 interactive games** (salary negotiation vs. live AI, job offer math, budgeting, freelance taxes, 30-year portfolio sim); shipped zero-login product with **Gemini 2.0 Flash + server-side scoring** in under 24 hours

COMPETITIONS & ACTIVITIES

UNCF STEM Scholar (2026) — Top 50 HBCU Nationwide | Truist Ascent Immersion (TMCF x Truist, Oct. 2026) | HBCU Innovation Challenge (TMCF/CSAA/Guidewire, Jun. 2026) | UNCF AI Certificate | ACM Programs Chair | Hack NCAT 1st Place | FRC World Championship | FidHacks @ Fidelity | GDG